INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TAB, SIGNAL, PLASTIC
TAB SET, SIGNAL, PLASTIC

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20407, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic signal tabs and tab sets.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type, class, style, shape of cut out and size. Plastic signal tabs shall be of the following types, classes, styles, shape of cut outs, and size of tabs, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. Nonprojection type.
- Class A. Transparent.
  - Style 1. Crimped without cut out.
  - Style 2. Crimped with cut out.
    - a. Shape of cut out - Square.
    - b. Shape of cut out - Circle.
    - c. Shape of cut out - Triangle.
  - Style 3. Slip over.
    - Size a. 1 inch long - for 1/4-inch index strip.
    - Size b. 3/8 inch long - for 1/6-inch index strip.
- Class B. Opaque.
- Class C. Metal reinforced.

Type II. Projection type.

1.2.2 Colors. (See 3.2.1.1.1, 3.2.1.1.3, 3.2.1.2, 3.2.1.3, 3.2.2, and 6.2.)

1.2.3 Tab sets. (See 3.3 and 6.2.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-504 - Plastic Sheet and Film, Cellulose Acetate.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Plastic. Plastic shall conform to types I or II of Federal Specification L-P-504. Thickness shall be 0.010 inch ± 0.001 inch.

3.1.2 Metal. Metal used for reinforcing shall be such that the grip of reinforced tabs will not be affected by the test described in 4.4.1 (see 3.2.1.2).

3.2 Design and construction.

3.2.1 Type I, nonprojection.

3.2.1.1 Class A, transparent tabs. Class A, transparent signal tabs shall be rectangular in shape. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that signal tabs will not adversely affect the visibility of printed and typewritten matter. The tabs may be furnished as individual signals or in scored strips. Tabs in strip form shall break cleanly and evenly at scoring.

3.2.1.1.1 Style 1. Style 1 tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards. One end of the tabs shall be crimped so that they will lock on pocket file cards, can be easily slid to another position on cards, and removed entirely without removing cards from pockets. The length of tabs shall be 7/8 inch ± 1/16 inch. The width of tabs shall be 1/4 inch ± 0.010 inch. Tabs shall be furnished in blue, brown, green, orange, pink, purple, red, and yellow, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1.1.2 Style 2. Style 2 tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards. One end of the tabs shall be crimped so that they will lock on pocket cards, can be easily slid to another position on cards, and removed entirely without removing cards from pockets. Style 2 tabs shall be furnished with cut outs which shall be in the shape of squares, circles, and triangles, as specified (see 6.2). The distance from the bottom of the cut outs to the inside edge of crimps shall be 5/32 inch ± 0.010 inch. The length of tabs shall be 7/8 inch ± 1/16 inch. The width of tabs shall be 1/4 inch ± 0.010 inch. Tabs shall be furnished in blue.

3.2.1.1.3 Style 3. Style 3 tabs shall be designed for use as slip-over signals for strip files. The design of the tabs shall be such that they will not become detached from the index strips under normal conditions of use. The top surface of the tabs shall be rectangular in shape. Size a tabs shall be one inch ± 1/16 inch in length and shall slide easily on index strips 1/4 inch in width. Size b tabs shall be 3/8 inch ± 1/32 inch in length and shall slide easily on index strips 1/6 inch in width. Tabs shall be furnished in blue, green, orange, and red, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1.2 Class B. Class B signal tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards. Tabs shall be opaque (non-transparent) and rectangular in shape. One end of the tabs shall be crimped so that they will lock on pocket cards, can be easily slid to another position on cards, and removed entirely without removing cards from pockets. The tabs may be furnished as individual signals or in scored strips. Tabs in strip form shall break cleanly and evenly at scoring. The length of tabs shall

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be 7/8 inch ± 1/16 inch. The width of tabs shall be 1/4 inch ± 0.010 inch. Tabs shall be furnished in black; smoke; white; and in alternate black and white vertical stripes; as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1.3 Class C. Class C signal tabs shall be designed for use with visible file cards. The tabs shall be made of transparent plastic reinforced with metal. The reinforcement may be in the form of a flat piece of formed metal, or two strands of wire parallel to the longer dimension and imbedded between two sheets of plastic. When tabs are made of two sheets of plastic, the total thickness of both sheets shall conform to the thickness requirements of 3.1.1, and wires shall be more than 1/8 inch but less than 3/16 inch apart. Except for the open end, the tabs shall be rectangular in shape. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that signal tabs will not adversely affect the visibility of printed and typewritten matter. The tabs may be furnished as individual signals or in scored strips. Tabs in strip form shall break cleanly and evenly at scoring. The edges of tabs shall be free from metal projections which might constitute a personal hazard to the user. The length of tabs shall be 7/8 inch ± 3/16 inch. The width of tabs shall be 5/16 inch ± 0.010 inch. Tabs shall be furnished in blue, green, red, and yellow, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.2 Type II, projection type. Type II signal tabs shall be designed for use in progressive signaling with visible file pockets and cards. The tabs shall be of transparent plastic. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that signal tabs will not adversely affect the visibility of printed and typewritten matter. The shape, size, and any special characteristics shall be as specified (see 6.2). The tabs shall be furnished in blue or orange, as specified (see 6.2).

3.3 Tab sets. Tab sets, when desired, shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.4 Legends. Tabs and tab sets, when desired, shall be lettered or numbered as specified (see 6.2). Unless otherwise specified, letters and numbers shall be black.

3.5 Workmanship. All edges of tabs shall be cleanly cut and smooth. Tabs shall be free from foreign matter, scratches, scuffs, cracks, blisters, bubbles, pimples, pits, tears, cuts, holes, or other defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all plastic signal tabs of the same type, class, style, shape of cut out, and size offered for delivery at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection. Random sample boxes of tabs shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, inspection level I, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab, except all tabs within a box, containing a set, shall be examined as described in 4.3.

4.2.3 Sampling for test (type I, class C only). Random sample boxes of tabs shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected just prior to the closing operatings. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be II and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in Table I. Any tab in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective tabs in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE I.- Classification of signal tab defects

Examine	Defects
Material:	
Thickness of plastic	Not as specified in 3.1.1.
Design and construction:	
Type, class, style, shape of cut out, and size of tab.	Not as required in 1.2.1, 3.2.1, and 3.2.2.
Shape of tab	Not as required in 3.2.1.1, 3.2.1.2, 3.2.1.3, and 3.2.2.
Crimping	Not as required in 3.2.1.1.1, 3.2.1.1.2, and 3.2.1.2.
Scoring	When furnished in strips, scoring not as required in 3.2.1.1, 3.2.1.2, and 3.2.1.3.
Color	Not as required in 3.2.1.1.1, 3.2.1.1.2, 3.2.1.1.3, 3.2.1.2, 3.2.1.3, and 3.2.2.
Tab sets:	When desired, not in conformance with 3.3.
Legends:	When desired, not in conformance with 3.4.
Workmanship:	Not in conformance with 3.5.

4.4 Test. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested as described in 4.4.1. Any tabs in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective tabs in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1 Grip performance (type I, class C only). Slide tab over paperboard stock with a thickness of 0.012 inch ± 0.0005 inch. Remove tab and slide it over a single sheet of manifold paper with a thickness of 0.0015 inch ± 0.0005 inch. Remove and examine for compliance with 3.1.2.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with Table II.

TABLE II. Classification of Preparation for Delivery Defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY
(For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102).

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A or B. One hundred (100) tabs, of one type, class, and description or ten tab sets of like description, each set individually packaged in accordance with industry standards, shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566; PPP-B-665; or to PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the applicable box specification or appendix thereto. Alternatively, 100 tabs may be packaged in a plastic box, hinged covered, with a snap lock closure.

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5.1.1.1 Intermediate packaging. Eighteen unit packages, of type I, class A tabs or tab sets, of like description, shall be intermediate packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566; PPP-B-665; or to PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the applicable box specification or appendix thereto. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), type I, class C tabs shall not require intermediate packaging.

5.1.2 Level C. The signal tabs shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Tabs of one type, class and description, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-601; PPP-B-621; or to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c, style RSC. Each box shall have a case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547 and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Case liners shall not be required for fiberboard boxes when all seams and joints are waterproof sealed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the fiberboard box specification. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I, class A. Eighty (80) intermediate packages of tabs or tab sets, of like description, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 1, style RSC. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.2 Type I, class C and type II. Ten unit packages of tabs, of like description, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-566; PPP-B-665; or to PPP-B-676. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.2.3 Level C. The signal tabs shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.1.1 and 5.2.2 (see 6.3).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Plastic signal tabs and tab sets are intended for use in directing attention to data recorded on visible record files.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, style, shape of cut out (as applicable), and size of tabs (as applicable) required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Color (see 1.2.2, 3.2.1.1.1, 3.2.1.1.3, 3.2.1.2, 3.2.1.3, and 3.2.2).
(d) Shape of cut out required of style 2 tabs (see 3.2.1.1.2).
(e) Size of style 3 tabs required (see 3.2.1.1.3).
(f) Shape, size, and any special characteristics required of type II tabs (see 3.2.2).
(g) Components of tab sets, when required (see 1.2.3 and 3.3).
(h) Lettering or numbering of legend, when required and color of legends if other than black (see 3.4).
(i) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.4).
(j) Intermediate packaging for type I, class C, tabs, when required (see 5.1.1.1).

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6.3 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of Stores Stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue or shipment to eventual user.

6.4 Federal specifications do not include all types, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable to Federal Government requirements.

6.5 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

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